SCOUTING REPORT

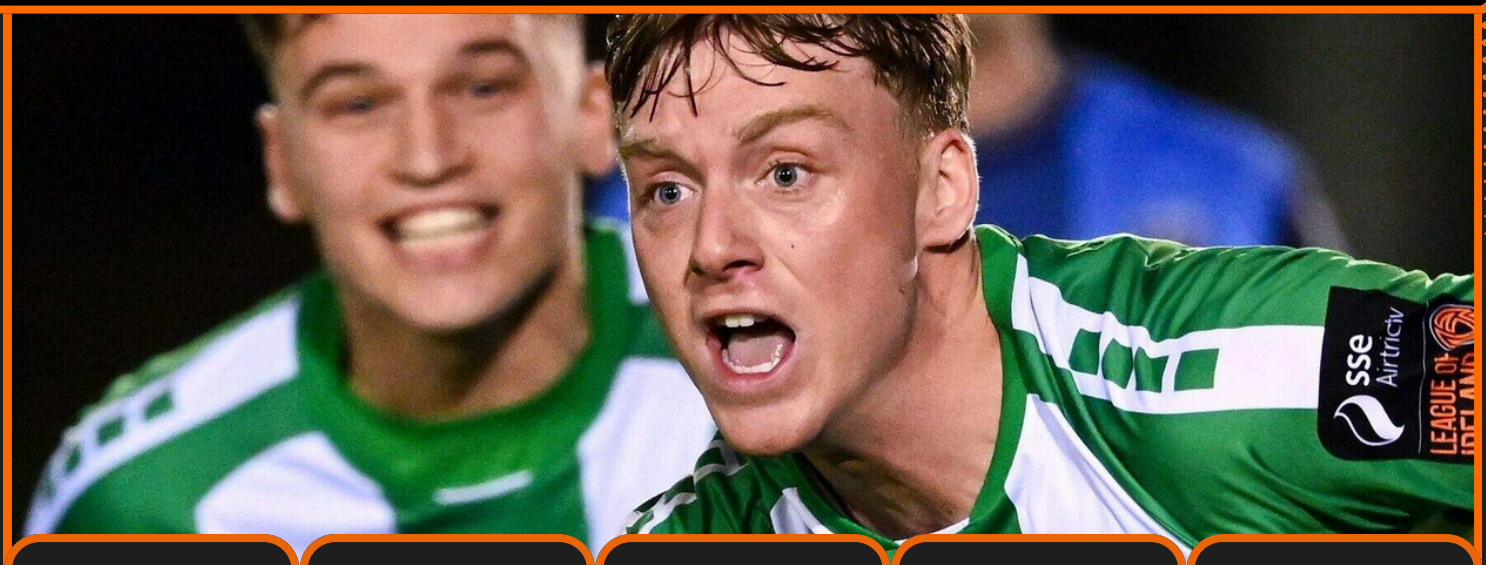
CIAN DOYLE



POS	NAT	DOB
CM		07.01. 2005

FULL REPORT

OVERVIEW



POS	HT	CLUB	NAT	FOOT
CM	1.78M	BRAY WANDERERS		R

BACKGROUND

Cian Doyle is a 21-year-old Irish central midfielder currently playing for Bray Wanderers in the League of Ireland First Division. A product of Shelbourne's academy system, Doyle progressed through the club's underage structure before making the move to Bray Wanderers ahead of the 2025 season.

Operating primarily as a central midfielder but also capable of functioning in a deeper midfield role, Doyle has established himself as a regular starter in Bray's midfield unit, starting all 16 league appearances and averaging 88 minutes per game during the current campaign.

His profile is unusual for a young midfielder. Rather than standing out through attacking production, he derives value through positioning, ball recovery, defensive activity and game management. The combination of age, availability and defensive output makes him an interesting recruitment profile for clubs seeking a developmental midfielder capable of operating within structured systems.

(ACADEMY) (ACADEMY)

2025/26

SEASON OVERVIEW

16
Games Played

1,407
Minutes Played

7.21
Average Rating

DEFENCE

10
Yellow Cards

0
Red Cards

2.3
Clearances/90

2.7
Dribbled Past?90

9.3
Duels Won/90

38%
Duels Won %

2.9
Aerials Won/90

14.8
Ball Recoveries/90

2.1
Fouls

1.6
Was Fouled

2025/26

SEASON OVERVIEW

16	1,407	7.21
Games Played	Minutes Played	Average Rating

ATTACKING

1	0	0.06	1,407 MINS	1.3
Goals	Assists	Goals Per Game	Scoring Frequency	Shots Per Game
0.4	5%	0.4	0.8	93%
On Target /90	Goal Conversion	Key Passes/90	Succ Dribbles/90	Dribble Success %
32.4	70%	4.5	48%	55%
Accurate Passes/90	Pass Accuracy	Long Balls/90	Long Ball Accuracy	Accurate Crosses/90

PROFILE OVERVIEW

Doyle profiles as a defensive-minded central midfielder whose game is built around positioning, anticipation and ball recovery.
His statistical profile is heavily weighted towards defensive involvement rather than creative influence. The standout number is 14.8 ball recoveries per game, suggesting a player who consistently reads situations well, arrives in useful positions and contributes heavily during transitions.

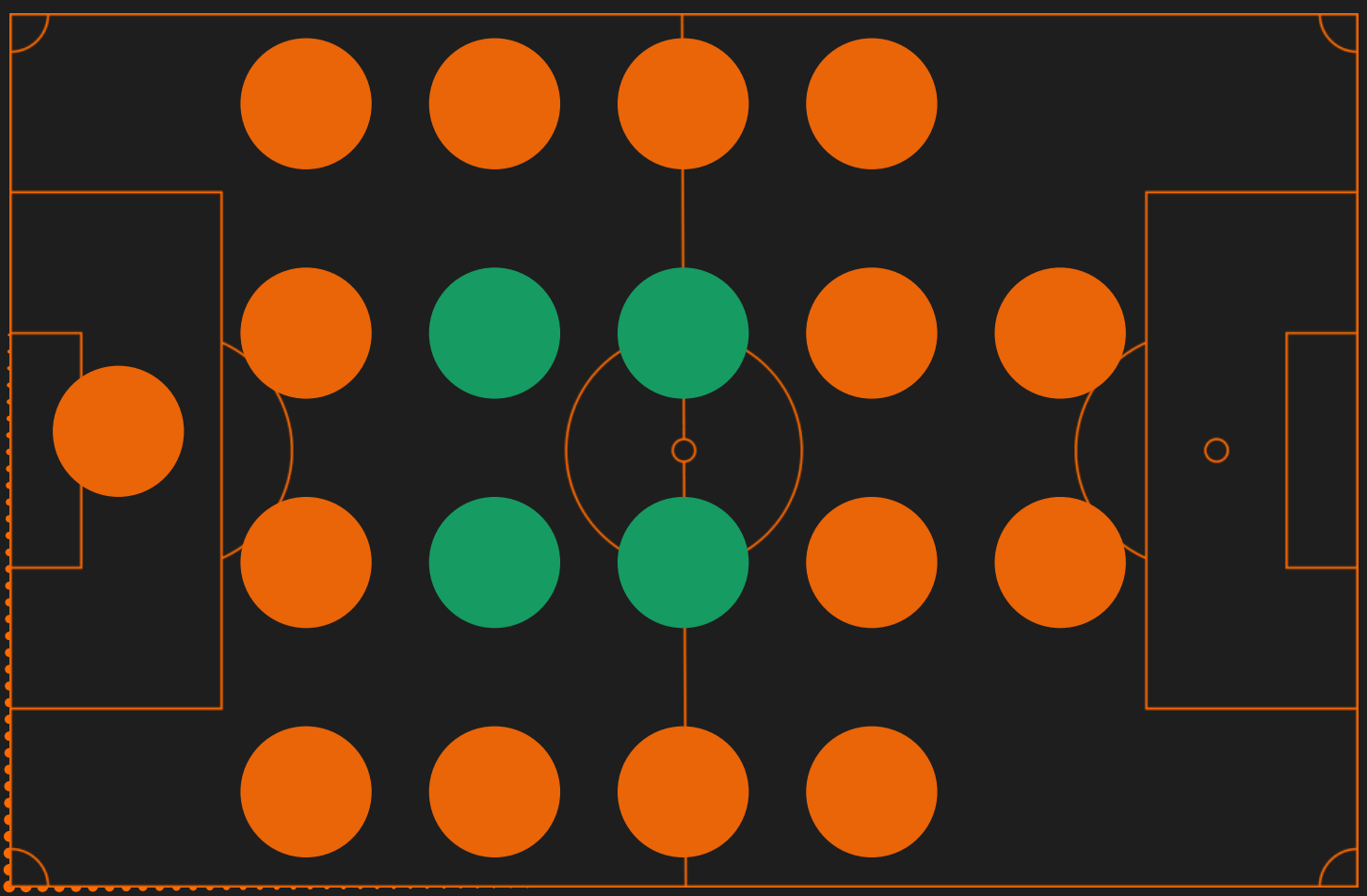
His game currently revolves around collecting second balls, protecting central spaces and supporting defensive phases. He is constantly involved. His recovery volume, aerial contribution and duel involvement point towards a midfielder comfortable operating in congested areas and undertaking significant off-ball responsibility.



In possession, he remains functional rather than expansive. His passing profile is relatively conservative and his creative output remains limited. While he demonstrates good ball security when dribbling, he does not currently dictate games through progression or chance creation.
The profile is clear. Doyle's strongest qualities are defensive awareness, work rate and positioning.

The primary weaknesses are discipline, passing consistency and attacking influence.

POSITION OVERVIEW



Position - Center Midfield

Position - Defensive Midfield

IN POSSESSION

In possession, Doyle is currently a functional rather than expansive midfielder.

His first instinct is generally to maintain possession and support circulation rather than force progression. He receives comfortably in central areas and is capable of moving the ball efficiently over short and medium distances.

His dribbling profile is particularly interesting. While he attempts relatively few take-ons, his 93% success rate suggests a player who chooses moments carefully and rarely loses control when carrying possession.
His passing profile remains mixed. While he completes a respectable volume of passes, his 70% completion rate and modest creative output indicate there is still significant room for improvement in distribution.

The next technical jump is becoming more progressive. Increasing his ability to break lines through passing and contribute more consistently in attacking phases would significantly increase his value.

OFF THE BALL

Off the ball is where Doyle currently looks most effective.
His defensive workload is substantial. The standout figure of 14.8 ball recoveries per game reflects a midfielder who consistently influences matches through positioning, anticipation and defensive awareness.

He appears comfortable defending central areas and regularly contributes to regaining possession. His aerial involvement is also notable for a midfielder, winning 2.9 aerial duels per game at a 53% success rate.

His willingness to compete is clear, but discipline remains a concern. Ten yellow cards in 16 appearances is a significant figure and suggests he can occasionally become over-aggressive or arrive late into challenges.

The next stage of development is improving defensive decision-making.

Better timing and game management would allow him to maintain his defensive output while reducing unnecessary disciplinary issues.

TECHNICAL

Technically, Doyle's strongest qualities are his ball security, first touch and ability to operate within compact spaces.

He receives cleanly and generally looks comfortable when collecting possession in central areas. His dribbling success rate reflects a player capable of protecting the ball and escaping pressure when required.
His passing remains the biggest technical growth area. While he possesses adequate range, his overall execution can be inconsistent and he currently lacks the progressive passing profile associated with higher-level possession midfielders.

Crossing and final-third delivery are not major components of his game at present, while his attacking output remains relatively limited.

Right now, his technical game is built around reliability and retention rather than creativity and progression.

Player	Club	Role	Minutes Played	Ball Recoveries Per Game
Cian Doyle	Bray Wanderers	DM / CM	1407	14.8
Greg Bolger	Cork City	No.6 / Ball-winning CM	1257	11.8
Aaron Bolger	Galway United	No.6 / Deep CM	1423	5.3
Adam McDonnell	Bohemians	CM	718	1.7
Dawson Devoy	Bohemians	CM	1710	6.9
Matthew Healy	Shamrock Rovers	CM / Defensive 8	1557	6

PHYSICAL

Doyle's physical profile is built around endurance, mobility and work rate rather than physical dominance.

He has shown the durability required to start every league match and consistently complete high minute volumes despite the demands of senior football.

His movement allows him to cover significant ground and remain involved throughout matches. He appears comfortable operating across large areas of midfield and repeatedly engaging in defensive actions.

The main limitation is physical confrontation. While he competes willingly, his duel success rate highlights difficulties against stronger opponents in direct contests.

Further physical development should improve his ability to handle Premier Division intensity while maintaining his current defensive output.

Player	Club	Role	Minutes Played	Duels Won Per Game	Pass Accuracy
Cian Doyle	Bray Wanderers	DM / CM	1407	9.3	70%
Greg Bolger	Cork City	No.6 / Ball-winning CM	1257	6	74%
Aaron Bolger	Galway United	No.6 / Deep CM	1423	5.4	70%
Adam McDonnell	Bohemians	CM	718	2.2	88%
Dawson Devoy	Bohemians	CM	1710	4.9	88%
Matthew Healy	Shamrock Rovers	CM / Defensive 8	1557	4.4	89%

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Doyle's pathway suggests a player with strong resilience and coachability.
Breaking into senior football before establishing himself as a regular starter at Bray Wanderers reflects a willingness to adapt and continue developing. His consistent availability and minute accumulation point towards professionalism and trust from coaching staff.
There is evidence of responsibility within his game. He accepts defensive duties and remains heavily involved throughout matches rather than avoiding difficult work.
The primary concern is discipline. While his competitiveness is a positive trait, learning when to engage and when to manage situations more effectively will be important for long-term progression.
Overall, he appears to possess the mentality required to continue developing within a professional environment.



IMPRESSION OF PLAYER

Cian Doyle is a defensive-minded central midfielder whose strongest qualities are positioning, ball recovery and work rate. He currently projects as a strong First Division starter with Premier Division potential. Improving passing consistency, discipline and decision-making in possession will determine his ceiling. A developmental number six with clear defensive value and room for growth.

TOUCHLINE SPORT